



PRACTICAL FARM TOOLS

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# FSMA Exemption Calculator

A Farmer's Walkthrough — Determine your FDA Produce Safety Rule exemption status and generate the signed record that proves it.

`fsma-calculator-2026.vercel.app`

2026 Season · FDA Thresholds Current · Free & Offline-Capable

21 CFR Part 112

No Account Required

Works Without Internet

Data Stays on Your Device

## Why This Tool Exists

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If you grow and sell produce, the FDA's Food Safety Modernization Act (FSMA) Produce Safety Rule applies to you — unless your farm is small enough or local enough to qualify for an exemption. Most small farms *do* qualify. The challenge is that the exemption isn't paperwork-free: the dollar thresholds adjust for inflation every year, the math uses a three-year rolling average, and if you claim a Qualified Exemption you are required by federal regulation to keep a written record showing you checked your eligibility annually (21 CFR § 112.7).

This calculator handles all of that. You enter three years of sales figures, it computes your status using the FDA's current thresholds, and it generates a citation-backed, signed record you can file and hand to an inspector. The whole process takes about ten minutes.

### Before You Start — have these figures on hand:

- Gross produce sales for the past three years (your Schedule F, sales ledger, or farm tax records)
- Total food sales for the same three years
- Sales made directly to consumers or to local restaurants/stores in-state or within 275 miles

Estimates give you a preview; exact figures make your printed record solid.

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## The Three Possible Results

FULLY EXEMPT

**§ 112.4(a)**

Avg produce sales ≤ \$34,324

QUALIFIED EXEMPTION

**§ 112.5**

Avg food < \$686,476 & majority local

NOT EXEMPT

**Part 112**

Fully covered by the rule

| Status                              | What It Means                                                                                                                         | What You Need to Do                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fully Exempt</b>                 | Your average produce sales are at or below the FDA threshold. The rule doesn't cover your farm.                                       | Keep sales records on file; print and sign the app's record as documentation.                                         |
| <b>Partially Exempt (Qualified)</b> | Your food sales are under the limit and most go to local buyers. You skip the general requirements but have two specific obligations. | Label your products with farm name and address; keep an annual written determination — which this app prints for you. |
| <b>Not Exempt</b>                   | Your farm is fully covered by the Produce Safety Rule. The app tells you exactly which threshold you crossed.                         | Implement full PSA rule standards; complete a PSA Grower Training course; contact your state produce safety program.  |

Thresholds shown are the 2026 FDA inflation-adjusted figures, derived from GDP Implicit Price Deflators using sales years 2023, 2024, and 2025.

# Using the Calculator

## 1 Tell It About Your Farm

Open the app and fill in your farm's legal name, physical address, owner name, and contact details. This information appears on your printed exemption record, so use the name on your tax filings.

Everything you type is **saved automatically on your own device** — nothing is uploaded anywhere, there is no account to create, and no one else can see your numbers. If you close the app and return next week, your information is still there.

The screenshot displays the 'Practical Farm Tools' app interface, which is an FSMA Exemption Calculator & Records Builder. The app is offline ready, updated on 2026-06-10, and saved locally. It is divided into two main panels: 'Farm Information' and 'Your Exemption Status'.

**Farm Information Panel:**

- 1 Farm Information:** Enter your farm's details. This information is saved automatically on your device and will appear on your official exemption record printed for the inspector.
  - Farm Legal Name:** Green Meadows Farm LLC
  - Farm Physical Address:** 123 Main Road, Anytown, ME 04000
  - Owner/Operator Name:** Jordan Taylor
  - Phone Number:** 207-555-0199
  - Farm State / Territory:** Maine (ME)
  - Email Address:** owner@greenmeadowsfarm.com
- 2 Sales Records & Averages:** Enter your gross sales for the three years shown below. All figures are saved automatically as you type. **Tip:** Enter 0 for a year your farm operated but had no sales; leave a year blank only if your farm was not yet in business that year.
  - Claiming exemption for **2026**

**Your Exemption Status Panel:**

- 3 Your Exemption Status:**
  - CALCULATED STATUS:** Fully Exempt (Produce Sales ≤ \$34,324)
  - Your farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule because your rolling average produce sales (\$27,000) do not exceed the FDA's inflation-adjusted limit of \$34,324. You do not need to comply with the general requirements of the Produce Safety Rule.
  - 3-Year Rolling Averages:**

|                            |           |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| Produce Sales Avg:         | \$27,000  |
| Full Exemption Limit:      | \$34,324  |
| Total Food Sales Avg:      | \$85,000  |
| Qualified Exemption Limit: | \$686,476 |
| Local Sales %:             | 76.5%     |
| Required Local %:          | > 50%     |
  - Action Steps to Prove Exemption:**
    - Click **Print / Save Exemption Record** below to generate your record.

*Your exemption status updates live in the right-hand panel as you type.*

## 2 Enter Three Years of Sales

For each of the three years shown, enter three dollar amounts. The app explains exactly what counts in each column — right where you need it — but here is the short version:

| Field                           | Include                                                                                                                    | Leave Out                                                      |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Gross Produce Sales</b>      | Raw fruits, vegetables, herbs, sprouts, nuts, mushrooms                                                                    | Hay, meat, dairy, grains, processed or value-added foods       |
| <b>Total Food Sales</b>         | Everything people or animals eat: produce, meat, dairy, eggs, grain, hay, livestock feed                                   | Timber, wool, ornamental plants, non-food items                |
| <b>Qualified End-User Sales</b> | Sales directly to consumers (farmstand, CSA, markets, online); sales to restaurants or stores in-state or within 275 miles | Wholesale to distributors, out-of-area buyers beyond 275 miles |

**New or partial-year farm?** Enter **0** for a year you were in business but had no sales of that type. Leave a year **blank** only if your farm was not yet in business at all that year. The calculator adjusts the average accordingly — a zero counts in the denominator, a blank does not. This distinction matters for your final number.

## 2 Sales Records & Averages

Enter your gross sales for the three years shown below. All figures are saved automatically as you type. **Tip:** Enter **0** for a year your farm operated but had no sales; leave a year **blank** only if your farm was not yet in business that year.

Claiming exemption for **2026**

Uses 2023 – 2025 sales records

| Year | Gross Produce Sales<br>Raw fruits, veggies, herbs, nuts, mushrooms. <b>Exclude</b> hay, meat, dairy, grains, processed foods. | Total Food Sales<br>All human food + animal feed. <b>Must include</b> produce, meat, dairy, eggs, grains, hay. <b>Exclude</b> wood, wool. | Qualified End-User Sales<br>Sales directly to consumers (CSA, stand, market) or local stores/restaurants in-state or < 275 miles. |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | \$ 25,000                                                                                                                     | \$ 80,000                                                                                                                                 | \$ 60,000                                                                                                                         |
| 2024 | \$ 27,000                                                                                                                     | \$ 85,000                                                                                                                                 | \$ 65,000                                                                                                                         |
| 2025 | \$ 29,000                                                                                                                     | \$ 90,000                                                                                                                                 | \$ 70,000                                                                                                                         |

*Each column explains what to include and exclude, right where you need it.*

## Reading and Using Your Result

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### 3 Read Your Result

As you type, the status panel on the right does the math the same way the FDA does — a three-year rolling average compared against the current inflation-adjusted thresholds — and shows you one of the three outcomes described on page 2. Each result includes a plain-language explanation of what it means and what to do next.

The panel shows three key numbers:

- Your **produce sales rolling average** vs. the \$34,324 full-exemption limit
- Your **total food sales rolling average** vs. the \$686,476 qualified-exemption limit
- The **percentage of your food sales** that went to qualified end-users (must exceed 50% to qualify)

### 3 Your Exemption Status

#### CALCULATED STATUS

#### Partially Exempt (Qualified Local Farm)

Your farm qualifies for a Qualified Exemption (partial exemption). Your average total food sales (\$220,000) are below the FDA inflation-adjusted limit of \$686,476, and the majority of your food sales (75.0%) are sold directly to qualified end-users (local consumers, stores, or restaurants). You must comply with modified requirements under 21 CFR §§ 112.6 and 112.7.

#### 3-Year Rolling Averages

|                    |          |
|--------------------|----------|
| Produce Sales Avg: | \$45,000 |
|--------------------|----------|

|                       |          |
|-----------------------|----------|
| Full Exemption Limit: | \$34,324 |
|-----------------------|----------|

|                       |           |
|-----------------------|-----------|
| Total Food Sales Avg: | \$220,000 |
|-----------------------|-----------|

|                            |           |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| Qualified Exemption Limit: | \$686,476 |
|----------------------------|-----------|

|                |       |
|----------------|-------|
| Local Sales %: | 75.0% |
|----------------|-------|

|                   |       |
|-------------------|-------|
| Required Local %: | > 50% |
|-------------------|-------|

#### Action Steps to Secure Qualified Exemption:

1. Click **Print / Save Exemption Record** below to generate your record.
2. Sign and date the printed annual written determination.
3. File it alongside your sales logs or farm records (retain for at



least 3 years).

4. **Labeling Rule (21 CFR § 112.6):** Ensure your farm name and physical address are prominently shown at your farmstand, market placard, invoices, or produce labels.

*A Qualified Exemption result. Your rolling averages are shown next to each FDA limit, and the panel tells you exactly what to do to secure your status.*

**Borderline result?** If your numbers land close to a threshold, re-check your inputs for accuracy. Estimates are fine for a preview, but if you are within a few thousand dollars of a cut-off, use your exact Schedule F figures. A farm sitting right at \$34,324 in average produce sales is still fully exempt — the rule covers only farms *above* the threshold.

## 4 Print Your Record

Once your farm name and sales numbers are entered, the **Preview Exemption Letter** and **Print / Save Exemption Record** buttons unlock. The document it generates is a formal annual determination — not a generic printout — containing:

- Your complete farm profile and contact information
- Your three-year sales ledger with the rolling-average math shown line by line
- The exact FDA dollar thresholds for the current claim year, with their source date
- The specific federal regulations (CFR citations) that apply to your farm's status
- A compliance declaration and signature block

ANNUAL DETERMINATION OF NON-COVERAGE

GREEN MEADOWS  
FARM LLC

STATUS (21 CFR § 112.4(a))

Annual Exemption Documentation

FARM PROFILE

Farm Legal Name: Green Meadows Farm LLC  
Physical Address: 123 Main Road, Anytown, ME 04000  
Owner / Operator: Jordan Taylor  
Contact Details: 207-555-0199 |  
owner@greenmeadowsfarm.com

RECORD DETAILS

Assessment Year: 2026  
Calculation Date: June 16, 2026  
FDA Threshold Date: June 10, 2026  
Status: FULLY EXEMPT (PRODUCE  
SALES ≤ \$34,324)

FULLY EXEMPT (PRODUCE SALES ≤ \$34,324)

Your farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule because your rolling average produce sales (\$27,000) do not exceed the FDA's inflation-adjusted limit of \$34,324. You do not need to comply with the general requirements of the Produce Safety Rule.

This farm asserts that it is NOT COVERED by the FSMA Produce Safety Rule under 21 CFR § 112.4(a) for the 2026 coverage year.

3-YEAR SALES LEDGER & MATH EXPLANATION

| ASSESSMENT YEAR         | GROSS PRODUCE SALES (\$) | GROSS TOTAL FOOD SALES (\$) | QUALIFIED END-USER SALES (\$) | QUALIFIED END-USER % |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------|
| 2023                    | \$25,000                 | \$80,000                    | \$60,000                      | 75%                  |
| 2024                    | \$27,000                 | \$85,000                    | \$65,000                      | 76%                  |
| 2025                    | \$29,000                 | \$90,000                    | \$70,000                      | 78%                  |
| 3-Year Average          | \$27,000                 | \$85,000                    | \$65,000                      | 76.5%                |
| FDA Inflation Threshold | \$34,324                 | \$686,476                   | N/A                           | > 50% Required       |

Preview the completed document on screen before printing.

# Signing, Filing, and Planning Ahead

| 3-Year Average          | \$27,000 | \$85,000  | \$65,000 | 76.5%          |
|-------------------------|----------|-----------|----------|----------------|
| FDA Inflation Threshold | \$34,324 | \$686,476 | N/A      | > 50% Required |

**APPLICABLE REGULATORY CITATIONS**

**Legal Citation: 21 CFR § 112.4(a)** — A farm is not covered by the Produce Safety Rule if its average annual value of produce sold during the previous 3-year period does not exceed \$25,000 (adjusted for inflation: \$34,324 for the 2026 claim year).

**Recordkeeping Best Practice:** Although not covered by the rule, you should retain your yearly tax returns and crop sales records for at least 3 years to document and verify your exempt status during audits or inspections.

**COMPLIANCE DECLARATION**

*I hereby certify that the gross sales figures and distribution percentages detailed above are true, accurate, and correct representations of our farm's financial records to the best of my knowledge and belief. This record documents our farm's annual eligibility review under 21 CFR § 112.7. Supporting documentation (tax records, invoices, sales ledger receipts) is maintained at our farm headquarters and will be retained for as long as necessary to support our farm's status, and no less than 2 years, in accordance with 21 CFR § 112.164. These records will be made readily available to FDA or State of Maine officials for inspection and copying upon request in accordance with 21 CFR § 112.166; any records stored offsite will be retrieved and provided within 24 hours of request per 21 CFR § 112.162(a).*

CERTIFIED OWNER/OPERATOR  
SIGNATURE

Jordan Taylor  
PRINTED NAME & TITLE

DATE SIGNED

**ANNUAL DETERMINATION OF NON-COVERAGE**

GREEN MEADOWS  
FARM LLC

STATUS (21 CFR § 112.4(a))  
Annual Exemption Documentation

FARM PROFILE

RECORD DETAILS

Farm Legal Name: Green Meadows Farm LLC

Assessment Year: 2026

Every record includes the exact regulatory citations and a compliance declaration ready for your signature.

Sign the document, date it, and file it alongside your three years of sales records. If an FDA or state inspector ever asks how you determined your exemption status, you hand them this document.

**Tip:** In your browser's print dialog, choose **Save as PDF** instead of a printer to create a digital copy. Keep both a paper copy in your farm office and the PDF with your digital farm records.

**Retention requirement (21 CFR § 112.164):** Keep your exemption record for as long as it is needed to support your status — and no less than two years from the date it was created.

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## 5 Optional: Look Ahead to Next Year

The **Future Year Exemption Planner** (inside the app, marked optional) lets you enter what you expect to sell this year and projects next year's status using your existing records plus your estimate. It uses the same calculation engine as the official determination, so the projection is consistent with how the real number will be calculated.

It is useful for deciding whether to expand a crop, take on a new wholesale account, or begin preparing for full coverage before you cross a threshold.



## Future Year Exemption Planner (Optional)



Plan ahead for next year (2027). This tool pre-populates your records from Step 2 and lets you enter projected sales for the current year to predict your future exemption status.

### Projected Current Year: 2026

Projected Gross Produce Sales

\$ 30,000

Projected Total Food Sales

\$ 95,000

Projected Qualified End-User Sales

\$ 72,000

#### PROJECTED EXEMPTION STATUS

**Projected Exempt**

Based on projections, your estimated rolling average produce sales (\$28,667) remain below the \$34,324 threshold. Your farm would remain **Fully Exempt** next year.

 **Exemption Math:** Next year's assessment will average your sales from 2024, 2025, and 2026 (Projected). Projections are compared against the latest 2026 thresholds as a baseline estimate. Next year's official limits will adjust slightly for inflation when FDA publishes updated cut-offs each spring.

*Enter projected sales for the current year and see where next year is likely to land.*

*Note: The planner uses the current year's FDA thresholds as a baseline. The actual limits for next year will adjust slightly when FDA publishes updated figures each spring. The projection is a planning estimate, not a formal determination.*

# Things Worth Knowing

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## It works without internet

Once you have opened the app once on a device, it works completely offline — in a barn, in a field, at a market with no signal. The **FDA Limits: 2026** badge in the header confirms the app has the correct year's thresholds loaded. Add the app to your phone's home screen (using "Add to Home Screen" in your browser) and it functions like a regular app.

## The dollar limits stay current

The thresholds are pulled from the FDA's official inflation-adjusted figures and updated each spring. The badge in the header shows the data date so you always know which year's numbers you're working from. If you open the app offline, it uses the most recently cached thresholds — the same figures shown in the table on page 2.

## Your data stays on your device

No sales figures are ever transmitted to a server. There is no account, no sign-up, and no one else has access to your numbers. The data lives in your browser's local storage on your own device. The "Clear saved data" button at the bottom of the app wipes it completely if you ever need to.

## It is free

No trial, no subscription, no upsell. The tool is provided as a public service to help small farms understand and document their FSMA status.

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## If Your Farm Is Fully Covered

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If the calculator tells you that your farm does not qualify for either exemption, the Produce Safety Rule applies in full. This is not a penalty — it is a determination based on your sales volume and distribution patterns. The rule exists to establish food safety standards for farms of a certain size, and there is a clear path to compliance.

### Your immediate next steps if you are fully covered:

1. Complete a **PSA Grower Training course** — this is the FDA-recognized national training that satisfies the supervisor training requirement in 21 CFR § 112.22(c). Courses are offered in person, remotely, and online across the country.
2. Contact your **state produce safety program** or cooperative extension office. They provide on-farm technical assistance and can walk you through what the rule requires for your specific operation.
3. Review the **FDA's full guidance** for covered farms on the FSMA Produce Safety Rule page.

## PSA Grower Training — Find a Course Near You

The Produce Safety Alliance (Cornell University, in partnership with FDA and USDA) runs the official national grower training program.

[cals.cornell.edu/produce-safety-alliance/training/grower-training-course/upcoming-grower-trainings](https://cals.cornell.edu/produce-safety-alliance/training/grower-training-course/upcoming-grower-trainings)

## FDA FSMA Produce Safety Rule — Official Guidance

Complete regulatory text, compliance resources, and information for covered farms.

[fda.gov/food/food-safety-modernization-act-fsma/fsma-produce-safety-rule](https://fda.gov/food/food-safety-modernization-act-fsma/fsma-produce-safety-rule)

## The Calculator

Run your numbers, generate your record, and access this walkthrough online.

[fsma-calculator-2026.vercel.app](https://fsma-calculator-2026.vercel.app)

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*This walkthrough and the FSMA Exemption Calculator are provided to help farms understand and document their status under the FDA FSMA Produce Safety Rule (21 CFR Part 112). They are not legal advice and do not constitute an official FDA or state coverage determination. Farms with complex operations, mixed-use facilities, or sales figures close to a threshold should consult their state produce safety program or cooperative extension office. The operator is solely responsible for verifying their exemption status and maintaining the required supporting records. · Practical Farm Tools · [fsma-calculator-2026.vercel.app](https://fsma-calculator-2026.vercel.app)*